



सत्यमेव जयते



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Climate Change Adaptation



Benoit Marquet/UNDP India

Millennium Development Goal:

Goal 1 Eradicate extreme poverty and hunger

Goal 7: Ensure environmental sustainability

Targets:

- Halve, between 1990-2015, the proportion of people living on less than a dollar a day
- Integrate the principles of sustainable development into country policies and programmes and reverse the loss of environment resources

Relevant India Development Goal:

Reduction of poverty ratio by 15 percentage points by 2012

Background

India is highly vulnerable to various natural hazards such as droughts, floods, heat waves and cyclones. The effects of climate change are adding a new and more intractable dimension to the existing risk profile of vulnerable areas. It is believed that climate change will alter the number, severity, frequency and complexity of climate-induced hazards. With this uncertainty, and more importantly, with new areas experiencing extreme events, it becomes critical to adopt an integrated climate risk management approach. Vulnerability to climate change is determined, in large part, by people's adaptive capacity. Integration of disaster risk reduction into national and local development policies and plans is considered one of the key processes to promote a sustainable and climate resilient development paradigm. Communities, especially poor women and men, need to be supported in adopting and incorporating risk reduction concerns into their day-to-day lives, livelihoods and occupational patterns.

The Government of India (Ministry of Home Affairs) and UNDP's joint Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) Programme aims to strengthen institutional structures to undertake disaster risk reduction activities at various levels, and develop preparedness for recovery. The Australian Agency for International Development (AUSAID)-UNDP Climate Change Adaptation programme will address a crucial dimension of these vulnerabilities by supporting specific activities to enhance climate change induced risk management capacities (adaptation, disaster mitigation and risk reduction) in districts across flood-prone areas of Odisha and drought-prone areas of Madhya Pradesh.

Project Information

Area: Crisis Prevention and Recovery

Budget: US\$ 920,888

Duration: 2011–2014

Implementing Partner(s): UNDP

Other Partner(s):

Samaj Pragati Sahyog (SPS),
Madhya Pradesh
Regional Centre for Development
Cooperation (RCDC), Odisha
Society for Women Action
Development (SWAD), Odisha

Location(s):

West Nimar district in Madhya Pradesh
and Puri district in Odisha

Objectives

The project aims to build the resilience of poor women and men to climate change and enhance disaster risk capabilities in West Nimar district (Madhya Pradesh) and Puri district (Odisha) through integrated water management and incorporation of climate change adaptation in the state Disaster Management Plan. This is to be achieved through:

- Developing models of community-based management of water resources. This will involve participatory vulnerability assessment and strengthening of communities
- Integrating water management and climate change risk concerns into disaster management planning at district and gram panchayat levels
- Informing state-level policy and planning process on climate change and disaster risk management on adaptive water management practices like rain water harvesting, sustainable drainage system, plantations, etc

Results so far

- A training manual for participatory vulnerability analysis that serves as a reference to trained volunteers to gather information on vulnerability related to climate change induced disasters has been developed. Volunteers have been trained in Odisha to enable effective local participation in vulnerability analyses
- Participatory ground water aquifer mapping and preparation of integrated water use action plan has been undertaken in Madhya Pradesh
- Ongoing climate related vulnerability assessments in both districts will provide a basis for an action plan for integrated water management

Looking to the Future

- Continue to support emerging national priorities and policies and provide adequate technical support
- Enable greater understanding of the linkages between climate change and disaster risk management

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